

RAA Scout Briefing – Meeting Summary

Rajasthan Royals Academy Australia
Scout Team Outreach Meeting

1. Gold-Tier Selection Criteria

Players meeting "Gold-tier" criteria should be prioritised for contact. These players must meet **all three** of the following:

- Talented – Gold Standard player (VMCU level or equivalent potential)
- Interested – Would be receptive to the program opportunity
- Familiar – Pre-existing relationship with player or parents

2. Immediate Action Required

Within 24 hours: Review the scout sheet and highlight gold-tier names so calls can be allocated across the team.

3. Target Volume & Timeline

- Aim for approximately 50 contact entries (inquiries/contacts) by end of weekend
- This initial push builds momentum for the program launch
- Priority is collecting accurate email addresses to send official invitations

4. Calling Protocol

Objective of Each Call:

If you DON'T have their email: Inform them of the nomination → Collect their email address so we can send the official invitation

If you ALREADY have their email: Inform them of their nomination → Let them know to expect the official invitation in their inbox

Key Actions:

- Inform the player they have been identified by the Royals scouting network as emerging talent
- Confirm they are happy to be contacted about the opportunity
- Collect contact details (email and phone) and consent
- Present the news enthusiastically – get them excited!

Ethical Rules:

- Only use contacts you have obtained freely through your scout role
- Do not use private databases or contacts from other roles
- Coordinate with other scouts to avoid duplicate outreach to the same player
- For underage players: contact parents or ensure familiarity with the family before speaking to minors

Contact Order:

Top-down approach: Contact higher-tier players first to avoid perception issues (lower-tier players receiving invites before top talent).

5. Data Capture

Use the Call Notes section on the Scouting Sheet to record:

- Player Name & Date
- Parent/Guardian name
- Phone number
- Email collected
- Scout name
- Outcome: Email collected / Already had email – nomination confirmed / Not interested / Call back required
- Notes for any follow-up

Post any difficult or unusual questions ("curly ones") to the group chat immediately so the team can provide a consistent answer.

6. Program Overview – Key Talking Points

The Opportunity:

- First IPL Academy in Melbourne – this pathway has never existed in Australia before

- Direct connection to Rajasthan Royals (IPL), Paarl Royals (SA20), Barbados Royals (CPL)
- Player has been identified by our scouting network as emerging talent worth investing in
- First intake – being part of the foundation group is something that only happens once

Program Structure:

- 12 weeks starting early April 2026 – perfect launch into 2026/27 season
- Two sessions per week – one weeknight evening, one weekend
- Location: Cutting Edge Cricket, Melbourne (primarily indoor)
- Talent as young as 11 through to open age adults – we select on talent, not age
- Entry level: VMCU level or around this ability
- Structured squads with dedicated squad coach tracking each player's development

What's Included:

- 70% T20 focused / 30% application to longer formats
- Holistic development: mental performance, emotional management, problem-solving, tactical, physical, technical
- Individual Development Plans – skills, fitness, mindset, recovery, life
- Video analysis and state-of-the-art technology
- Sports psychology, nutrition, strength & conditioning
- Official Royals apparel – hat, training shirt, shorts
- Performance data reviewed by Royals Group coaches globally

Selection Process:

Invitation → Register Interest → Selection Team Reviews → Possible Trials

- Program capped at approximately 98–120 players
- Even if not selected in first intake, details stay on file – the Royals are building something long-term

Pricing:

- \$3,900 – \$4,300 depending on age group
- 24+ sessions over 12 weeks = approximately \$160–180 per session or \$50–60 per hour
- Compare: private coaching \$100–150/hr, elite tennis \$400–800/wk, elite soccer \$300–500/wk
- This gives coaching PLUS pathways that don't exist anywhere else in Australia

7. Pathway Opportunities (Performance-Based)

IMPORTANT: These opportunities are **potential** and **performance-based** – **not guaranteed**. Communicate this clearly.

- Potential match opportunities against external opposition (based on performance)
- Potential invitation to Jaipur, India – Royals High Performance Centre
- Potential trial opportunities with Rajasthan Royals, Paarl Royals, or Barbados Royals
- Visits from Royals coaches, scouts, and franchise players
- Tours are pay-to-participate (fees announced when tours are confirmed)

8. Leadership Team

- Siddhartha Lahiri – Royals Group Head of International Player Development
- Andy Crook – Managing Director, RR Academy Australia
- Steven Crook – Director of Talent (330+ professional matches, 2x T20 Blast titles)
- Alex Lewis – Head Coach (20+ years producing players for Premier Cricket & Pathway)

9. Women's Pathway Focus

"Talent is talent. The Royals back emerging cricketers regardless of gender."

- T20 is the main pathway opportunity (WBBL/Women's IPL growth)
- Focus on preparing U15–U18 girls for future franchise, state, and premier opportunities
- Target players likely to play premier ones or state level within approximately 3 years
- Recruit premier women's 1s/2s players as cadet coaches to provide role models and coaching depth
- The reason why for girls is to be a part of a franchise level development program that no one in the country is offering outside of state level pathways. This is a new pathway.

10. If You Don't Know the Answer

Never make up an answer. Use this approach:

1. Acknowledge: "That's a great question – I want to make sure you get accurate information..."

2. Redirect: "Let me grab your email so we can send the official invitation – it covers all the details and includes direct contact information for any specific questions."
3. Create urgency: "Places are limited and this is the first intake. Let me get your details now so you don't miss out."

If they're not interested: "No problem – I appreciate your time. If things change, their details are on our radar. This is just the first intake – the Royals are building something long-term here. Thanks again."

11. Key Reminders

- Stick to provided talking points and FAQs – do not improvise outside them
- Communicate "identified status" (on a talent list) – do not promise selection
- Build buzz and keep outreach ethical
- If unsure about an answer, collect the email and escalate the question to the group
- GOAL: Collect their email (if you don't have it) or confirm their nomination (if you do). Get them excited!

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